

Chapter 30-9 Translation

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In the evening, Liang Shi didn't have the servants prepare dinner.

She wasn't used to the food made by the servants at home—it was too sweet. Plus, since she was free, she went downstairs planning to make pasta for herself.

Before cooking, she even sent a message to Xu Qingzhu: [What are you having for dinner?]

Although they had previously agreed that if one was working overtime, the other didn't need to wait.

But Liang Shi had never had the habit of eating alone. In the past, when her assistant occasionally stayed overnight at her place, she would also make a portion for her assistant.

However, Xu Qingzhu was probably busy and didn't reply.

So she ate by herself.

After dinner, she stayed in the living room watching movies.

The TV in the living room was large with clear picture quality. This time she didn't trust the movie labels and actually opened an animated film to watch.

It was unique to this world, called "Rabbits Don't Cry."

Seeing the novel name and the rather cute rabbit drawn on the cover, she clicked to watch it.

It had a bit of a dark fairy tale flavor.

It wasn't until after eight o'clock that Xu Qingzhu came home.

She looked exhausted. Seeing Liang Shi watching a movie, she greeted her and changed shoes before going upstairs to wash up.

As she was going upstairs, Liang Shi asked: "Have you eaten dinner?"

Xu Qingzhu said: "Not yet."

Liang Shi: "..."

"What would you like to eat?" Liang Shi said. "I had pasta tonight. There's still some pasta sauce in the fridge. Should I cook you a bowl of pasta?"

"That's fine." Xu Qingzhu's voice was weak and listless: "Thank you."

"No problem." Liang Shi said as she went to the kitchen.

Xu Qingzhu went back to her room to remove her makeup and took a simple shower. After coming out, while drying her hair, she planned to use her phone to look at proposals, but when she pressed it, she found it was turned off.

The key thing was she didn't even know when it had turned off.

She dried her hair until it was half-dry, charged her phone, then went downstairs.

The aroma of food wafted up from downstairs, awakening her sense of taste.

She hadn't felt hungry before, but smelling the food aroma made her suddenly feel completely empty inside.

"It's ready." Liang Shi was already sitting on the sofa continuing to watch her animated film. "Eat quickly, or the noodles will get cold if you wait."

"Okay, thank you." Xu Qingzhu went to eat the noodles.

Her dining etiquette was excellent. Even when eating noodles, she didn't make any noise and ate at a good pace.

After finishing, she went to wash the dishes.

Having eaten someone's food, she felt obligated¹.

She was too embarrassed to immediately go back upstairs to continue working after eating, so she made small talk with Liang Shi: "Who helped you with the discharge today?"

"Zhao Xuning." Liang Shi said: "She seems to quite like me now."

After saying this, she immediately corrected: "Not that kind of like, just normal, friendly liking."

Xu Qingzhu laughed softly, and her whole person relaxed.

She felt Liang Shi had some kind of magic that always made people unconsciously relax.

"What was she like toward you before?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi said: "Didn't you know before? Of course she really disliked me."

She sheepishly touched her nose. "When I first woke up, she scared me by saying she'd gouge out my glands²."

Xu Qingzhu's gaze swept over her ears. "I didn't expect Dr. Zhao to have such childish moments."

"She's quite childish to begin with." Liang Shi said: "This morning I saw her watching Chibi Marukochan³ while on duty."

Xu Qingzhu: "...?"

After a while, she looked at the bouncing rabbit on TV and said meaningfully: "So you were infected by her?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She coughed lightly. "Occasionally returning to childhood innocence is quite good. Some films made by adults nowadays aren't very suitable for spiritual cultivation."

She emphasized the last four words heavily, seeming to specifically refer to the movie they had watched the night before last.

Xu Qingzhu understood and laughed softly without saying anything, sitting there to watch the little rabbit with her for a while.

Then she asked: "Do you need to use the study?"

Liang Shi shook her head: "I didn't go to work today, so I have no work. You use it."

Xu Qingzhu politely said: "Alright, thank you."

Footnotes

¹ **吃人嘴短 (chī rén zuǐ duǎn)** - A Chinese idiom meaning "having eaten someone's food, one's mouth becomes short" - implying that when you receive favors from someone (like being fed), you feel obligated to them and can't easily criticize or refuse them.

² **腺體 (xiàn tǐ)** - Glands. In omegaverse fiction, this specifically refers to the scent glands located near the ears/neck area that are important for Alpha/Beta/Omega biology and bonding.

³ **櫻桃小丸子 (yīng táo xiǎo wán zi)** - Chibi Maruko-chan, a popular Japanese anime and manga series about a young girl and her daily life. It's considered a children's show, which is why Xu Qingzhu finds it amusing that the serious Dr. Zhao watches it.